

Isolation and Characterization of Methicillin-Resistant *Staphylococcus aureus* Strains from Louisiana Retail Meats

We investigated the prevalence of *Staphylococcus aureus* and methicillin-resistant *S. aureus* (MRSA) in 120 retail meat samples from 30 grocery stores in Baton Rouge, LA. *S. aureus* strains were recovered from 45.6% of pork samples and 20% of beef samples, whereas MRSA strains were isolated from six meat samples (five pork samples and one beef sample). The MRSA isolates were of two strain types (clones), one harboring Pantone-Valentine leucocidin and belonging to pulsed-field gel electrophoresis type USA300 and the other one belonging to USA100.